



Which document, and when

Engineering runs on its paperwork, which is a dull sentence for a true thing: the record is what lets you defend the work later. This page says which document you are filling in, and when.

Document	When	What it asks for
Daily Logbook	Every day	Three intervals, filled in as the day goes. Highlights, roadblocks, photographs, then a synthesis and what you do next class.
Weekly Planner	Monday	Goals for the week, the tasks that get you there, and how long you think each will take.
Weekly Reflection	Friday	What actually happened against Monday's plan, what you would improve, and a sketch of the improvement.
Project Reflection	End of a project	Whether the result is a fair reflection of what you can do, what went wrong, and what you would change.
Do Now! Reflection	After a Do Now	One skill: what it taught you, the steps you followed, where it goes next, and whether you could repeat it alone.
Design Brief and Initial Planner	Starting a project	Problem, design statement, criteria, constraints, goals and deliverables. The document that fixes what "finished" means.
Mid-Project Design Review	Partway through a project	Where you are, what is left, why this concept, and the single element most likely to fail and needing a test.
Instructor Meeting Notes	After every one-on-one	Follow-up, new business, what was said, and the action items with names and dates against them.
Research Log	Capstone and Independent Focus	A spreadsheet. One new source a day is the target; more during brainstorming and research.
Part List	Any project with more than one part	A spreadsheet. Every part in the design including the fasteners, what it is made of, and whether you make it or buy it.
Order Request Form	When you need parts	A spreadsheet. Quantity, cost, links, and the reason — the reason is the column that gets it approved.
Project Gantt Chart	Projects with a schedule	A spreadsheet. Break the work into tasks, then put them on a calendar to find out where two of them collide.

The Daily Logbook replaces both the old Logbook Template and the Engineering Daily Journal. They were the same document under two names and were being handed out at the same time. There is one now.

If a document asks you something you cannot answer, that is worth saying out loud rather than leaving blank. A gap you can explain is information; a gap you cannot is just a gap.